

DUBAI 2020

"India and the UAE will cooperate on security issues"

SHEIKH AHMED BIN SAEED AL MAKTOUM CHAIRMAN AND CHIEF EXECUTIVE, EMIRATES AIRLINE & GROUP

India has a special place for us. Every time we visit India we feel closer to it and our bond deepens. We feel the similarities between our beliefs and values and the strength of our trade and economic relations. For decades it has not only been about the trade of goods for all the Arab states, but about the exchange of cultures as well. India, too, has been influenced by the Islamic civilisation that founded many states and the monuments that became immortal like the tremendous Taj Mahal and the great Qutub Minar. Many schools and universities have also been established here. Both the cultures have intermingled with each other and coexist peacefully. In all this, Urdu, which was the language of the kings, thinkers, the literati and intellectuals, has survived for more than four centuries.

Our relationship with the third millennium country, as India is called, is rooted deep in history, as many of the Indian traders chose to establish their businesses, along with their lives, in the UAE. Their population has almost hit the two million mark. The Indian people work side by side with the people of UAE in the building of the state in different fields. We will never forget the contribution of this great country in building our economy and opening the doors for our businessmen to invest till it became the largest trading partner for us.

No doubt the theme of this conclave, New Decade: Great Expectations, is very realistic as the coming decade will

SHEIKH MOHAMMED BIN RASHID AL MAKTOUM, UAE VICE-PRESIDENT, PM & RULER OF DUBAI



"I just met the Prime Minister of India and the talk was excellent. Our strong partnership with India has gotten stronger. The people of UAE and the people of India have a history of strength together and I am very pleased today to see how well-placed India and UAE are in numbers around the world. I am very happy that the people of both countries have such great respect for each other. We want to move forward and take this opportunity as partners. I am sorry I couldn't be with you, but I am leaving a delegation here; Sheikh Ahmed bin Saeed Al Maktoum, my cousin, will speak to you. I thank the India Today Group and appreciate your invitation to speak at this forum."

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